

Area of Study 1C – Islam

Overview

This area of study comprises a study in depth of Islam as a lived religion in the United Kingdom and throughout the world.

There are four sections: Beliefs and Teaching; Practices; Sources of Wisdom and Authority; Forms of Expression and Ways of Life.

Students will be expected to study Islam within the context of the wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian.

Students should compare and contrast two areas of belief and practice within Christianity and Islam:

- Beliefs about the afterlife and their significance (1.8)*
- The practice and significance of worship (2.3)*.

Students should recognise that Islam is one of the many religious traditions in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism and Sikhism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content. Students should also recognise that within Islam there may be more than one perspective in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed. Common and divergent views within Islam in the way beliefs and teachings are understood and expressed should be included throughout, including reference to Sunni and Shi'a traditions.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs and practices to Muslims today should be explored throughout the four sections.

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The Six Beliefs of Islam: their nature, history and purpose, including Kitab al-iman 1:4; how they are understood and expressed in Sunni and Shi'a Muslim communities today; the importance of these principles for Muslims.
1.2	The Five Roots of 'Usul ad-Din in Shi'a Islam: Tawhid (oneness of Allah); 'Adl (Divine Justice); Nubuwwah (Prophethood); Imamah (Successors to Muhammad) and Mi'ad (The Day of Judgment and the Resurrection); the nature, history and purpose of the Five Roots with reference to their Qur'anic basis, including Surah 112 (the oneness of Allah); the importance of these principles for different Shi'a communities today, including Sevens and Twelvers.
1.3	The nature of Allah: how the characteristics of Allah are shown in the Qur'an and why they are important; Tawhid (oneness), including Surah 16:35-36, immanence, transcendence, omnipotence, beneficence, mercy, fairness and justice, Adalat in Shi'a Islam.
1.4	Risalah: the nature and importance of prophethood for Muslims, including Surah 2:136; what the roles of prophets teach Muslims, exemplified in the lives of Adam, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Musa, Dawud, Isa, and Muhammad.
1.5	Muslim holy books (Kutub) – the nature, history, significance and purpose of Muslim holy books with reference to: the Qur'an; the Tawrat (Torah), including Surah 5:43-48; the Zabur (Psalms), including Surah 4:163-171; the Injil (Gospel), including Surah 57:27; and the Sahifah (Scrolls). Divergent Muslim views about the importance of the holy books in their lives today.
1.6	Malaikah: the nature and importance of angels for Muslims; how angels Jibril, Isra'il and Mika'il are shown in the Qur'an, including Surah 32:11 and 2:97-98, and their significance for Muslims today.
1.7	al-Qadr: the nature and importance of Predestination for Muslims; how al-Qadr and human freedom relates to the Day of Judgement, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 78:685; divergent understandings of predestination in Sunni and Shi'a Islam; the implications of belief in al-Qadr for Muslims today.
1.8*	Akhirah: Muslim teachings about life after death; the nature of judgement, paradise and hell; how they are shown in the Qur'an, including Surah 17:49-72; divergent ways in which Muslim teachings about life after death affect the life of a Muslim today.

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	Ten Obligatory Acts of Shi'a Islam: their nature, history and purpose of the Ten Obligatory Acts; the diversity of practice and importance of Ten Obligatory Acts for Shi'a Muslims today; their basis in the Qur'an, including reference to Surah 9:71–73; divergent understandings of these principles within Sunni Islam, including links with the Five Pillars.
2.2	Shahadah as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role and significance of Shahadah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including reference to Surah 3:17–21; why reciting Shahadah is important for Muslims, and its place in Muslim practice today.
2.3*	Salah as one of the Five Pillars, including reference to Surah 15:98–99 and 29:45: the nature, history, significance and purpose of Salah for Sunni and Shi'a Muslims, including different ways of understanding them; how Salah is performed, including ablution, times, directions, movements and recitations, in the home and mosque and Jummah prayer.
2.4	Sawm as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, significance and purpose of fasting during Ramadan, including Surah 2:183–185; those who are excused from fasting and why. The significance of the Night of Power: the nature, history and purpose of the Night of Power; why Laylat al-Qadr is important for Muslims today.
2.5	Zakah as one of the Five Pillars and Khums: the nature, role, significance and purpose of Zakah and Khums, including Surah 9:58–60 and 8:36–42; why Zakah is important for Sunni Muslims; why Khums is important for Shi'a Muslims; the benefits of receiving Zakah or Khums.
2.6	Hajj as one of the Five Pillars: the nature, role, origins and significance of Hajj, including Surah 2:124–130 and 22:25–30; how Hajj is performed and why Hajj is important for Muslims; benefits and challenges of performing Hajj for Muslims.
2.7	Jihad: the origins, meaning and significance of Jihad in Islam; divergent understandings of Jihad within Islam, including the difference between lesser and greater Jihad; the conditions for declaration of lesser Jihad, including reference to Surah 2:190–194 and 22:39; the importance of Jihad in the life of Muslims.
2.8	The nature, origins, activities, meaning and significance of the celebration/commemoration of Id-ul-Adha, with reference to Surah 37:77–111, and Id-ul-Fitr in Sunni Islam, with reference to their place within Shi'a Islam; and Id-ul-Ghadeer, with reference to Hadith and the interpretation of Surah 5:3, and Ashura in Shi'a Islam, with reference to their place within Sunni Islam.

Students should have an understanding of:

3.1	The Qur'an: the revelation and compilation of the Qur'an, including Surah 53:4–18; its significance and authority within Islam today; divergent ways in which the Qur'an is used in the daily life of a Muslim: informal and formal worship, in the home, in the mosque, as a source of teaching and guidance.
3.2	The Prophet Muhammad: events in the life of the Prophet, including teaching and authority; his call, work in Makkah and Madinah, the Hijrah; the significance of these events and the Prophet Muhammad for Muslims today, including Surah 48:26–29.
3.3	The Seal of the Prophets, Surah 33:36–47: Muhammad's role as 'seal of the Prophets'; the final prophet; fulfilling the teachings of all other prophets, and as a role model to Muslims today; the significance of Muhammad as seal of the prophets and a role model today.
3.4	The divergent understandings of the significance of the family of the Prophet Muhammad: Caliph/Imam Ali (Ahl-ul-Bayt) in Sunni and Shi'a Islam and interpretations of Surah 33:32–34; the family of the Prophet in Ismaili Islam; the implications for questions of authority and the origins of the split between Sunni and Shi'a Islam.
3.5	The development and structure of the Hadith as a record of the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad: the structure and compilation of the Hadith, including isnad and matn; divergent understandings of their authority and significance within Sunni and Shi'a Islam today, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari, Sahih Muslim, and the Four Books.
3.6	Shari'ah Law: how it is agreed upon and the use of analogy (qiyas) and consensus (ijma), including interpretations of Surah 4:115; its divergence of use by the main schools of Sunni and Shi'a Islam; specific examples showing links between the Qur'an, Hadith, and Shari'ah; divergent understandings of the role and significance of judges (qadis) and scholars (the 'ulema) as sources of authority: the establishment of judges and scholars; examples of their rulings; the significance of authority within Islam today.
3.7	The Imam in Shi'a Islam, including reference to the Hadith of the pond of Khumm: history, major teachings and actions, divergent understandings of their contribution to Islam in Sunni and Shi'a thought, the doctrine of Nass, the Hidden Imam; the inerrancy and intercession of imams; the significance of the Imam for different forms of Shi'a Islam today.
3.8	The imam in Sunni Islam: the origins, nature, role of the imam in Sunni Islam, including Sahih al-Bukhari 73:34–37; divergent understandings of their contribution to individual and community life in Sunni and Shi'a thought.

Students should have an understanding of:

4.1	Muslim identity: divergent ways in which Muslim identity is expressed through the ummah in the ceremonies to welcome a child; expectations about modesty, including divergent interpretations of dress Surah 24:30–31; the origins, categories and significance of the laws of halal and haram; how they are applied to laws of food and drink, and riba (usury).
4.2	The mosque: divergent understandings of importance of the mosque, the design and different religious features of mosques, and furniture and objects in the mosque and their use in the various activities that take place, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 2:39.
4.3	The divergent understandings of the use, significance, meaning and purpose of calligraphy within Islam, including as a rejection of idolatry with reference to Surah 21:51–62: the way it is used to express belief, and how it may be used in the mosque and other settings.
4.4	Shi'a obligatory actions: understandings and implications of encouraging others to do good (Amr bil Maruf), including Surah 42:23–26; discouraging others from doing bad (Nahy Anil Munkar), Tawallah and Tabarra; love for the Prophet Muhammad and his family and disdain for their enemies; divergent understandings of their importance for Muslims in different traditions of Islam today.
4.5	The significance of Sufi ways of life: the origins of Sufism, orders, saints, and practice today. Sufi practices of fasting, and dhikr (remembrance) with reference to Surah 13:28: the nature, history, importance and purpose of fasting and dhikr and divergent understandings of their importance for Muslims today.
4.6	The role and significance of a Sheikh/teacher in Sufism: divergent understandings of the importance of a relationship with a teacher, the purpose of the teacher; the history, teachings and contributions of teachers: al-Ghazali, such as in his work <i>Revival of Religious Sciences</i> , outlining the Qur'anic basis of Sufism, ibn al-'Arabi and Rabi'a al-'Adawiyya.
4.7	The divergent understandings of use, significance, meaning and purpose of dance, music and poetry within Islam with specific reference to Sufism: the way these are used to express belief, as a devotional act, and how they may be used in other settings; divergent interpretations of the use of dance and music in Islam, including their rejection by some and interpretations of Sahih al-Bukhari 15:70 and 69:494.
4.8	The work of one named Muslim charity working for relief of poverty and suffering in the United Kingdom, what it does and why, including reference to sadaqah and Surah 2:271–274.